STUDIO VALENTINA

BEFORE YOU BUILD IN GEORGIA

Free Guide · Homeowner Checklist

From the lot to move-in day, step by step.

Edition 2026



Architecture + Interior Design

01 · 02 LAND & BUDGET

Start with the land and the numbers.

01

Land & lot

- [ ] Confirm zoning and allowed use with the city or county planning office
- [ ] Order a boundary survey; check setbacks, easements and FEMA flood zone
- [ ] Ask about HOA covenants or architectural review requirements
- [ ] No sewer? Schedule a soil / percolation test for a septic permit
- [ ] Verify water, power, gas and internet are available at the street

02

Budget & financing

- [ ] Get construction loan pre-approval before finalizing the design
- [ ] Budget soft costs: design, engineering, permits, impact fees, surveys
- [ ] Keep a contingency of at least 10% of construction cost
- [ ] Price finishes early (flooring, cabinets, fixtures) to avoid surprises

03 · 04 DESIGN & PERMITS

A home designed before it is built.

03 Design

- [ ] Write a wish list: rooms, lifestyle, storage, future needs
- [ ] Orient the house for sun, views and privacy before fixing the layout
- [ ] Approve floor plans, elevations and a finish schedule in writing
- [ ] Ask if your jurisdiction requires engineered or stamped drawings

04 Permits & team

- [ ] Hire a Georgia-licensed residential or general contractor
- [ ] Check the contractor's license, insurance and recent references
- [ ] Apply for the building permit with your local building department
- [ ] Confirm who schedules inspections and when each one happens

05 · 06 CONSTRUCTION & MOVE-IN

Protect the build until the keys are yours.

05

Contract & construction

- [ ] Sign a written contract with scope, price, schedule and payment draws
- [ ] Agree on how change orders are priced and approved
- [ ] Confirm builder's risk insurance is in place
- [ ] Collect lien waivers from the builder and subs with each payment
- [ ] Walk the site at key stages: foundation, framing, pre-drywall

06

Move-in

- [ ] Complete a final walkthrough and punch list
- [ ] Receive the certificate of occupancy before moving in
- [ ] Keep warranties, manuals and as-built drawings in one folder

NEXT STEPS

Ready to design your home?

01

Free intro call

Tell us about your lot, budget and how you want to live.

02

Clear proposal

Scope, timeline and fees before any work begins.

03

Design with intention

Plans, 3D renders and documentation ready to build.

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General information only, not legal, financial or engineering advice. Requirements vary by city and county; confirm with your local building department. English & Spanish.

Architecture + Interior Design

Custom homes in Georgia, designed by Studio Valentina.

